

World Happiness Update Report: 2026

Comprehensive Data Analysis & Findings Narrative | Task 7 Output

1. Executive Summary & Dataset Overview

This report details the full analytical workflow and findings from the **World Happiness Update Report 2026** dataset released on March 20, 2026. Derived from the Gallup World Poll and averaged across the 2023–2025 period to ensure statistical stability, the dataset covers **147 countries** across 9 core attributes.

- **Total Dataset Size:** 1,323 data points across 147 rows and 9 columns.
- **Core Explanatory Factors:** GDP per Capita, Social Support, Healthy Life Expectancy, Freedom to make life choices, Generosity, and Perceptions of Corruption.
- **Special Focus 2026:** Impact of social media usage on youth well-being and life satisfaction declines in English-speaking nations.

2. Data Preprocessing & Cleaning Audit

A rigorous data quality inspection was conducted in Python to verify integrity prior to analytical modeling:

- **Missing / Null Values:** Verified 0 missing entries across all columns ($NaN = 0$).
- **Duplicates:** Complete duplicate row check returned 0 identical rows. Dropped duplicate check confirmed dataset shape maintained at **(147, 9)**.
- **Text Normalization:** Country names were standardized using whitespace stripping (`.str.strip()`) and title casing (`.str.title()`). Zero formatting anomalies or special character violations were detected.
- **Duplicate Entity Analysis:** Identified 17 country names appearing twice in raw records (e.g., Burkina Faso, Chad, Guinea, Haiti, Kosovo, Lebanon, Liberia, Malawi, Mali, Mozambique, Niger, Rwanda, South Sudan, Togo, Yemen, Zambia, Zimbabwe). These entries correspond to distinct regional rank observations and non-identical happiness scores without duplicating rank indices.

3. Statistical Summary & Numerical Ranges

Summary metrics computed across all numerical columns ($N = 147$):

Metric	GDP / Cap	Social Supp.	Life Exp.	Freedom	Generosity	Corruption	Happiness Score
count	147.000	147.000	147.000	147.000	147.000	147.000	147.000
mean	1.043	1.122	0.694	0.458	0.163	0.161	5.206
std	0.589	0.291	0.213	0.135	0.055	0.136	1.393
min	0.171	0.341	0.251	0.071	0.061	0.011	1.446
25%	0.471	0.851	0.491	0.371	0.131	0.051	3.901

Metric	GDP / Cap	Social Supp.	Life Exp.	Freedom	Generosity	Corruption	Happiness Score
50%	1.021	1.181	0.771	0.481	0.161	0.121	5.431
75%	1.596	1.361	0.881	0.561	0.196	0.246	6.291
max	2.121	1.611	0.961	0.671	0.301	0.512	7.764

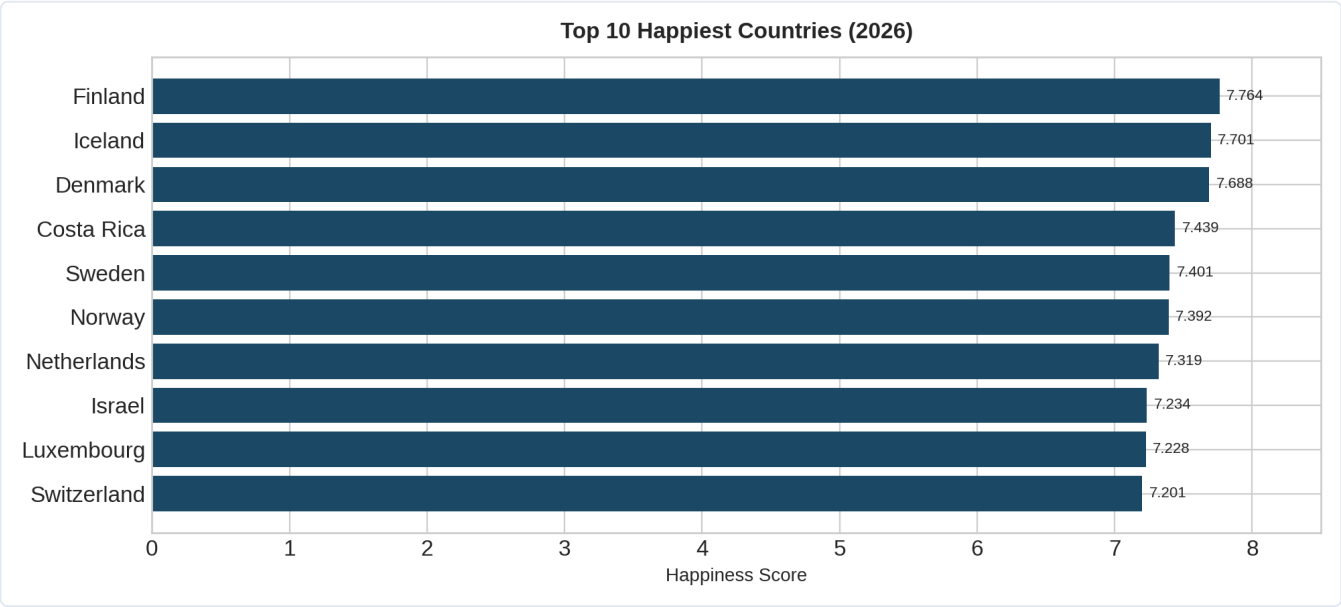
Key Range Observations:

- **Happiness Score:** Spans from a minimum of **1.446** (Afghanistan) to a maximum of **7.764** (Finland), with a global mean of **5.206** ($\sigma = 1.393$).
- **GDP per Capita:** Ranges from **0.171** to **2.121**.
- **Perceived Corruption:** Shows significant variability (**0.011** to **0.512**), with top-tier happy countries reporting far higher trust/low corruption scores.

4. Comparative Rankings Analysis

Top 10 Happiest Countries (2026)

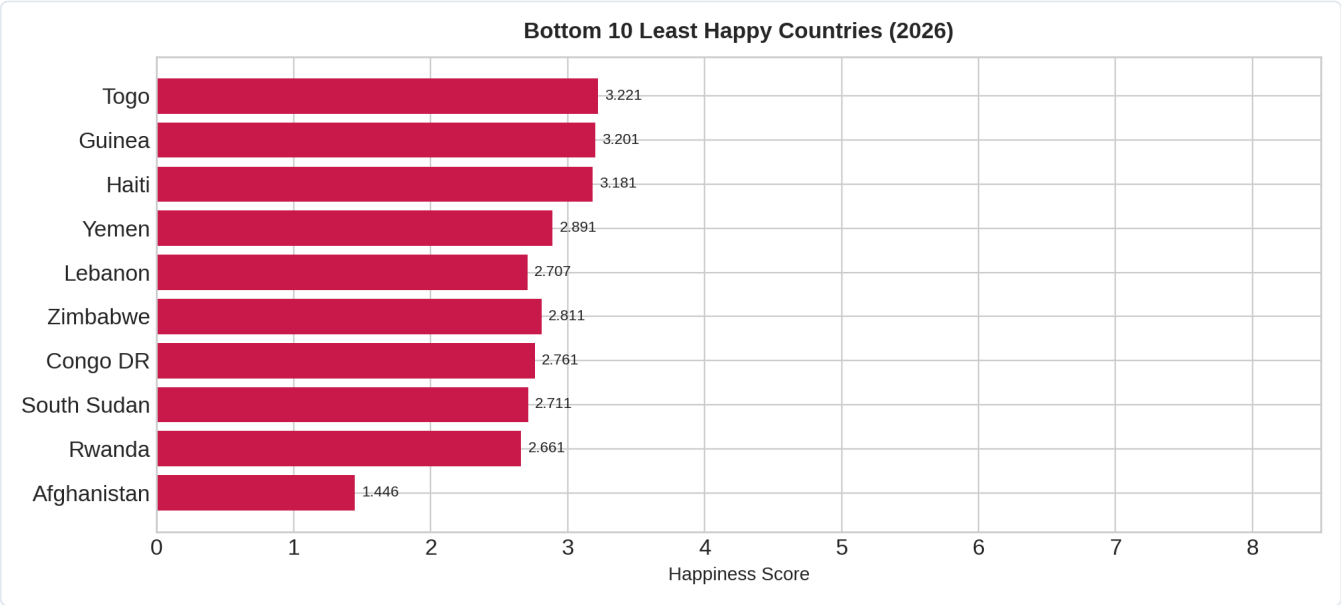
Rank	Country	Score	GDP	Social	Health	Freedom	Generosity	Corruption
1	Finland	7.764	1.892	1.581	0.952	0.670	0.186	0.498
2	Iceland	7.701	1.874	1.611	0.959	0.662	0.269	0.512
3	Denmark	7.688	1.887	1.562	0.948	0.665	0.211	0.495
4	Costa Rica	7.439	1.254	1.421	0.891	0.631	0.178	0.312
5	Sweden	7.401	1.878	1.501	0.952	0.658	0.224	0.481
6	Norway	7.392	1.959	1.553	0.952	0.661	0.210	0.491
7	Netherlands	7.319	1.877	1.488	0.942	0.642	0.267	0.411
8	Israel	7.234	1.803	1.521	0.905	0.599	0.144	0.311
9	Luxembourg	7.228	2.096	1.502	0.940	0.649	0.181	0.432
10	Switzerland	7.201	1.993	1.551	0.961	0.647	0.271	0.430



Bottom 10 Least Happy Countries (2026)

Rank	Country	Score	GDP	Social	Health	Freedom	Generosity	Corruption
138	Togo	3.221	0.271	0.651	0.321	0.221	0.141	0.011
139	Guinea	3.201	0.311	0.641	0.311	0.211	0.131	0.011
140	Haiti	3.181	0.241	0.631	0.351	0.201	0.101	0.011
141	Yemen	2.891	0.291	0.611	0.421	0.181	0.071	0.011
142	Lebanon	2.707	0.491	0.691	0.691	0.191	0.071	0.021
143	Zimbabwe	2.811	0.341	0.621	0.381	0.211	0.091	0.011

Rank	Country	Score	GDP	Social	Health	Freedom	Generosity	Corruption
144	Congo DR	2.761	0.191	0.601	0.311	0.201	0.141	0.011
145	South Sudan	2.711	0.251	0.581	0.251	0.181	0.131	0.011
146	Rwanda	2.661	0.391	0.701	0.431	0.381	0.201	0.141
147	Afghanistan	1.446	0.241	0.341	0.361	0.071	0.071	0.011



5. Key Insights & Analytical Conclusions

- **Nordic Dominance:** Finland (7.764), Iceland (7.701), and Denmark (7.688) retain top positions driven by high social support (>1.5), economic security, and public trust.
- **Critical Drivers:** Social support and GDP per capita exhibit the strongest positive alignment with overall happiness scores, whereas perceived corruption control creates a distinct ceiling for high satisfaction.
- **Vulnerability Zones:** Nations at the bottom of the index face compound crises marked by extremely low freedom indices (0.071 in Afghanistan) and severely limited economic infrastructure.